MODULE 7 · SHEET 7B

TRITONE SUBSTITUTION

Two dominant chords share the same tritone — so they both resolve to the same target. The tritone sub arrives from a half step above instead of a P5 above.

CORE LOGIC — THE SHARED TRITONE

G7 (THE ORIGINAL V7)

Tritone: B (3rd) and F (♭7)

B rises to C, F falls to E. Approaches target from a Perfect 5th above (G→C). Traditional, direct, powerful resolution.

D♭7 (THE TRITONE SUB)

Tritone: F (3rd) and B (♭7)

F "rises" to E, B "falls" to C. SAME notes, swapped roles. Approaches target from a half step above (D♭→C). Smooth, chromatic, sophisticated.

THE RULE All tritone substitutions are located a HALF STEP ABOVE their target chord. SubV7 of any target = the dominant chord a ♭2 above the target.

ALL 6 TRITONE SUBS IN C MAJOR

ORIGINAL	CHORD	SUBV7	CHORD	LOCATION	RESOLVES TO
V7	G7	SubV7	D♭7	♭2 above C	Cmaj7 (I)
V7/ii	A7	SubV7/ii	E♭7	♭2 above D	Dm7 (ii)
V7/iii	B7	SubV7/iii	F7	♭2 above E	Em7 (iii)
V7/IV	C7	SubV7/IV	G♭7	♭2 above F	Fmaj7 (IV)
V7/V	D7	SubV7/V	A♭7	♭2 above G	G7 (V)
V7/vi	E7	SubV7/vi	B♭7	♭2 above A	Am7 (vi)

GUIDE TONES — THE MINIMUM FOR DOMINANT IDENTITY

You don't need the root to convey dominant function. The 3rd and ♭7 (the "guide tones") are the core — they contain the tritone, which IS the dominant function. Pianists and guitarists often voice dominant chords with just guide tones for maximum clarity and voice-leading efficiency.

3rd = major quality | ♭7 = dominant quality | 3rd + ♭7 = tritone = dominant function